

American Express Company

Recommendation **STRONG BUY** ★★★★★

Price **USD 151.10** [as of market close Oct 13, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** **USD 235.00** **Report Currency** **USD** **Investment Style** **Large-Cap Blend**

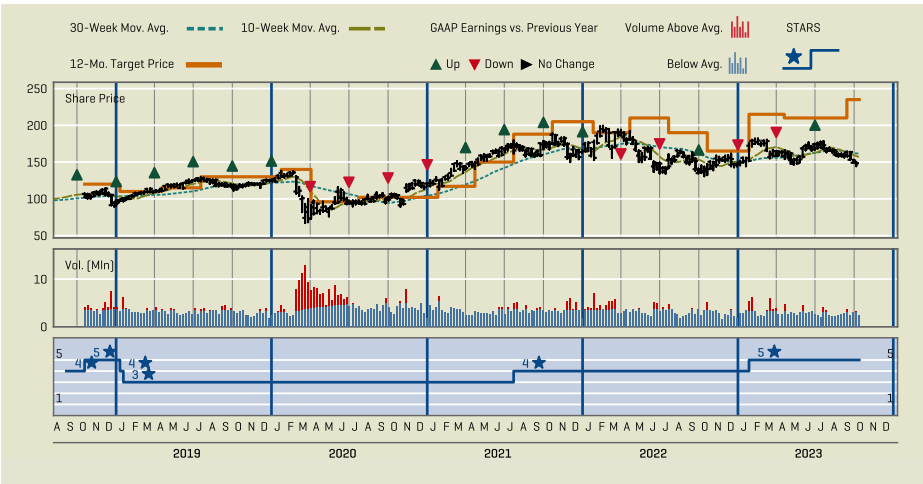
Equity Analyst **Alexander Yokum**

GICS Sector Financials **Sub-Industry** Consumer Finance **Summary** AXP is a financial services company offering charge and credit card products as well as travel-related services to consumers and businesses around the world.

Key Stock Statistics [Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports]

52-Wk Range	USD 182.15 - 130.65	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 11.30	Market Capitalization[B]	USD 111.28	Beta	1.19
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 9.83	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 12.87	Yield [%]	1.59	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	12
Trailing 12-Month P/E	15.37	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	13.37	Dividend Rate/Share	USD 2.4	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B+
USD 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	15,756.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	736.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	USD 2.32	Institutional Ownership [%]	65.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Alexander Yokum** on Sep 18, 2023 09:33 AM ET, when the stock traded at **USD 163.74**.

Highlights

- Following 25% revenue growth in 2022, we estimate total revenue growth of 14%-16% in 2023. Historically, growth has been slow for AXP with revenue compounding at under 2% a year from 2011-2020. However, AXP's products have begun to resonate with Millennial/Gen Z customers and AXP has been able to acquire new card holders at an accelerated rate. In Q2 2023, revenue growth decelerated to 12% as discount revenue [56% of revenue] grew just 8% given a slowdown in consumer spending.
- Strength was seen in net interest income [+32% and 21% of revenue] as results benefited from strong loan growth and net interest yield expansion. Net card fees grew 21% in the second quarter and have risen to 12% of total revenue vs. 8.5% in 2018. We view card fees as a differentiator for AXP as they continue to be a consistent revenue driver with unimpeded double-digit growth in each of the last 20 quarters.
- Total Network volume growth slowed to 9% from 16% last quarter. Positively, AXP has responded to slowing spending trends with prudent expense management and we note marketing spend fell 6% Y/Y. In Q2, net charge-offs (NCOs) came in at 2.1% vs. 1.1% in the prior year and pre-pandemic average of 2.4%-2.8%.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- Our Strong Buy opinion reflects AXP's improved credit profile. AXP came into the pandemic with industry leading credit quality given its wealthy customer base which is less prone to defaults than peers. Despite this, AXP was not content and we have been encouraged by further credit improvements. These upgrades have shown up in NCOs, which remain well below pre-pandemic levels. The same can't be said for the whole industry as most companies have hit pre-pandemic credit quality or even deteriorated past it. Additionally, card fees have shown positive momentum with an impressive 70% of new accounts coming on to fee-based products.
- Risks are higher-than-anticipated net charge-offs and delinquencies, leading to more provisioning expense; intensifying competition, leading to higher rewards and marketing expenses; and a decrease in consumer spending and loan balances.
- On July 21, we increased our 12-month target price by \$25 to \$235, applying a forward P/E of 18.3x our 2024 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 7.3x given more consistent earnings performance, lower credit risk, and superior growth prospects.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH
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Our risk assessment reflects AXP's globally recognized brand, which we think provides a durable competitive advantage, along with its business model that is less dependent on finance charges compared to peers. Further, AXP's more affluent and prime customer base insulates it from higher charge-off rates and delinquencies. This is slightly offset by the intensely competitive industry that requires large amounts of marketing and reward spending as well as risks from losing co-brand relationships and the rise of alternative payment systems.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 15,825	E 16,962	E 17,364	E 17,671	E 67,509
2023	14,281	15,054	E 15,471	E 16,172	E 60,978
2022	11,735	13,395	13,556	14,176	52,862
2021	9,064	10,243	10,928	12,145	42,380
2020	10,310	7,675	8,751	9,351	36,087
2019	10,364	10,838	10,989	11,365	43,556

Earnings Per Share (USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 2.98	E 3.26	E 3.32	E 3.31	E 12.87
2023	2.40	2.89	E 3.04	E 2.97	E 11.30
2022	2.73	2.57	2.47	2.07	9.85
2021	2.74	2.80	2.27	2.18	10.02
2020	0.41	0.29	1.30	1.76	3.77
2019	2.01	2.07	2.08	2.03	8.20

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [USD]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.6000	Sep 26	Oct 05	Oct 06	Nov 10 '23
0.6000	May 03	Jul 06	Jul 07	Aug 10 '23
0.6000	Mar 08	Apr 05	Apr 07	May 10 '23
0.5200	Dec 07	Jan 05	Jan 06	Feb 10 '23

Dividends have been paid since 1971 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.



American Express Company

Business Summary Sep 18, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW. American Express (AXP) is a globally integrated payments company that provides credit and charge cards to consumers, small businesses, mid-sized companies, and large corporations around the world. Additional services include fraud prevention services, the design and operation of customer loyalty programs, expense management products and services, and travel and lifestyle services. Founded in 1850, AXP has been in the Dow Jones Industrial Average since 1982.

BUSINESS SEGMENTS.

1) U.S. Consumer Services [45% of 2022 revenue] – issues a wide range of proprietary consumer cards and provides services to U.S. consumers, including travel and lifestyle services as well as banking and non-card financing products.

2) Commercial Services [26%] – issues a wide range of proprietary corporate and small business cards and provides services to U.S. businesses, including payment and expense management, banking, and non-card financing products. The segment also issues proprietary corporate cards and provides services to select global corporate clients.

3) International Card Services [17%] – issues a wide range of proprietary consumer, small business, and corporate cards outside the United States. Additionally, it provides services to AXP’s international customers, including travel and lifestyle services, and manages certain international joint ventures and loyalty coalition businesses.

4) Global Merchant and Network Services [12%] – operates a global payments network that processes and settles card transactions, acquires merchants, and provides multi-channel marketing programs and capabilities, services, and data analytics, leveraging AXP’s global integrated network.

5) Corporate & Others [-0%] – comprised of corporate functions and other unassigned businesses.

AXP is more globally diversified than many of its peers as 22% of its worldwide revenue comes from outside of the U.S.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE. We think one of AXP’s greatest assets is its globally recognized brand, which has consistently been rated as one of the most valuable brands in the world. AXP spent approximately 10% of total revenue [net of interest expense] on marketing and an additional 26% on Card Member rewards and services in 2022.

AXP operates a payment network whereby it facilitates payment transactions between merchants and card issuers. However, AXP is unique in that it operates a “closed-loop” payment system, whereby it maintains direct relationships with both the card members (as a card issuer) and merchants (as an acquirer), handling all aspects of these relationships. AXP is the bank that both issues the card and has a relationship with the merchant. This distinguishes AXP from network providers like Visa and Mastercard as they don’t issue credit cards. It is also different than credit card issuers like Capital One and Synchrony as they don’t maintain a network. This closed-loop integrated system allows AXP to see more data, which it can analyze and use to build anti-fraud algorithms or underwrite risk. However, it does open AXP to credit risk, although to a lesser extent than the credit risk to Capital One and Synchrony. The only other competitor that operates a similar closed-loop system is Discover Financial, which does not have the global exposure of AXP.

AXP also differentiates itself with its “spend-centric” business model that focuses primarily on driving spending on cards and deriving revenue from the merchant discount rate charged for each transaction. This differs from peers that derive most of their revenue from finance charges on the balance carried over from month-to-month. In fact, only 19% of AXP’s revenues came from net interest income [i.e., lending] in 2022 compared to peers, which derive a vast majority of their revenue from net interest income. This gives AXP the benefit of lower charge-off rates and credit risk, but can be a headwind in times of slowing spending and does not allow AXP to benefit as much from a rising rate environment.

IMPACT OF MAJOR DEVELOPMENTS. In December 2017, Marriott International announced it reached new agreements with JPMorgan Chase and AXP for its U.S. co-brand credit cards, extending AXP’s relationship with Marriott. The deal was previously in jeopardy after the Marriott-Starwood merger. While retaining the business is a positive, we note this appears to have come at the expense of lower economics.

In early February 2015, AXP announced that the long-standing partnership with Costco Wholesale Corp. [COST 558 ***] would end in June 2016. Under that arrangement, COST accepted only American Express charge/credit cards [in addition to cash and other debit cards].

MANAGEMENT. Long-time CEO Ken Chenault announced his retirement in 2017 after serving as CEO for 16 years and serving the company since 1981. Stephen J. Squeri assumed the role in February 2018. Previously he had been Vice Chairman (since July 2015) and has been at the company for more than 30 years. Squeri has accelerated card adoption with Millennials and Gen Z customers and has had success in building AXP’s position with small and mid-sized businesses.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. Total revenue increased 25% [foreign currency exchange adjusted] in 2022, due to a rebound in travel and elevated customer spending. Noninterest income increased 24%, driven by strong discount revenue [+25%] and net card fees [+17%]. After falling 3% in 2021, net interest income exploded 28% higher in 2022, driven by significant growth in loan balances. Noninterest expense growth of 24% was driven by higher rewards expense, business development, and salaries. Despite the excellent year, net income actually fell 7% on higher provisions for credit losses and significant net gains in 2021 stemming from the Amex Ventures strategic investment portfolio. As of June 30, 2023, AXP was less capitalized than it has been historically with a CET1 ratio of 10.6% versus the five-year average of 11.7%.

Corporate information

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Website

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Officers

**Executive VP, Corporate
Controller & Principal
Accounting Officer**

J. Lieberman Quinn

Chief Legal Officer

L. E. Seeger

Chairman & CEO

S. J. Squeri

Chief Financial Officer

C. Le Caillec

Board Members

C. D. Young

C. E. Phillips

D. L. Vasella

D. P. Majoras

J. C. Campbell

J. J. Brennan

K. L. Parkhill

L. A. Pike

L. W. Wardell

P. F. Chernin

R. de la Vega

S. J. Squeri

T. J. Baltimore

T. J. Leonsis

W. J. Clayton

Domicile

New York

Founded

1850

Employees

77,300

Stockholders

N/A

Auditor

PricewaterhouseCoopers
LLP

Quantitative Evaluations					
Fair Value Rank	1	2	3	4	5
	LOWEST HIGHEST Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued [1] to most undervalued [5].				
Fair Value Calculation	USD 170.45	Analysis of the stock's current worth, based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model suggests that AXP is undervalued by USD 19.35 or 12.81%			
Volatility	LOW		AVERAGE	HIGH	
Technical Evaluation	BEARISH	Since October, 2023, the technical indicators for AXP have been BEARISH"			
Insider Activity	UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE

	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	2.19	2.95	3.11	2.58
Price/Pretax Income	11.59	12.09	22.68	12.26
P/E Ratio	15.00	16.33	32.07	15.18
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	752.00	790.00	806.00	830.00

Past Growth Rate [%]	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years
Net Income	NM	3.59	22.28

Net Interest Margin [%]	7.70	6.77	6.88
Return on Assets [%]	3.60	3.15	3.34
Loan Loss Reserve [%]	N/A	N/A	N/A
Return on Equity [%]	32.05	27.12	29.06

Per Share Data [USD]	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	27.97	23.88	23.44	24.06	22.36	16.71	18.48	17.68	16.42	14.55
Earnings	9.85	10.02	3.77	7.99	7.91	2.99	5.61	5.05	5.56	4.88
Earnings (Normalized)	9.85	10.02	3.77	8.20	7.33	5.87	5.93	5.38	5.56	4.92
Dividends	2.08	1.72	1.72	1.64	1.48	1.34	1.22	1.13	1.01	0.89
Payout Ratio (%)	20.83	17.97	47.02	21.04	19.13	45.52	22.46	22.70	17.69	17.52
Prices: High	199.55	189.03	138.13	129.34	114.55	100.53	75.74	94.75	96.24	90.79
Prices: Low	130.65	112.10	67.00	93.23	87.54	74.74	50.27	67.57	78.41	56.24
P/E Ratio: High	20.30	18.90	36.60	15.80	15.60	17.10	12.80	17.60	17.30	18.50
P/E Ratio: Low	13.30	11.20	17.80	11.40	11.90	12.70	8.50	12.60	14.10	11.40

Net Interest Income	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Non Interest Income	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Loan Loss Provision	2,182	-1,419	4,730	3,573	3,352	2,760	2,027	1,988	2,044	1,832
% Expense/Operating Revenue	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Pretax Income	9,585	10,689	4,296	8,429	8,122	7,425	8,042	7,938	8,991	7,888
Effective Tax Rate	21.60	24.60	27.00	19.80	14.80	63.00	33.20	35.00	34.50	32.10
Net Income	7,514	8,060	3,135	6,759	6,921	2,748	5,375	5,163	5,885	5,359
Net Income [Normalized]	6,179	6,201	2,590	5,220	5,076	4,667	4,521	5,185	5,713	5,143
% Net Interest Margin	7.70	6.40	6.20	7.20	6.90	6.50	6.20	6.20	6.10	5.60

Investment Securities	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Total Loans	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Total Assets	228,354	188,548	191,367	198,321	188,602	181,196	158,893	161,184	159,103	153,375	
Non Perform Assets/Total Assets	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	
Common Equity	24,711	22,177	22,984	23,071	22,290	18,261	20,501	20,673	20,673	19,496	
% Return on Assets	3.60	4.24	1.61	3.49	3.74	1.62	3.36	3.22	3.77	3.50	
% Return on Equity	32.10	35.70	13.60	29.80	34.10	14.20	26.10	25.00	29.30	27.90	

American Express Company

Sub-Industry Outlook

We have a positive fundamental outlook on the consumer finance sub-industry. Within the sub-industry, our outlook is more positive for companies with a prime and affluent customer base, while we are more cautious on companies that target subprime customers.

Despite U.S. credit card debt recently surpassing the \$1 trillion mark, we believe loan balances still have room to run. Although staggering on the surface, credit card loans comprise just 6% of consumer debt. In fact, credit card debt is just 22% of discretionary debt and one-twelfth the size of consumer mortgages. As such, we believe credit card issuers are in a favorable position to see above-trend loan growth rates for several years without a serious threat of overburdening their target customers. To provide some perspective, before the pandemic, when the economy was relatively strong in 2017-2019, credit card debt varied from 6.0% to 6.6% of consumer debt. Furthermore, when accounting for inflation, credit card debt is up just 3% over the past five years and is down 10% over the past 20 years.

We expect credit quality deterioration to slow in upcoming quarters. Negative headlines have been rampant in recent months as significant Y/Y credit deterioration has been observed for all major credit card issuers. However, it's important to note that credit quality was historically strong coming out of the pandemic as consumers were flush with cash; thus, Y/Y comparisons are disingenuous, in our view. Instead, if we compare to 2019 levels, we find that credit quality is in line or even slightly stronger than this pre-pandemic benchmark. Don't get us wrong, we do expect credit quality to deteriorate further in upcoming quarters, but we think this expected degradation has more than been accounted for in the industry's depressed multiples.

Over the past few years, interest in Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) solutions exploded as they are often interest-free, allow consumers to spread out payments of products, and have a fast approval process that does not require good credit. Merchants tend to be supporters of BNPL

solutions as customers often spend significantly more than when paying with other methods. However, given the rapid tightening by the Fed, we expect BNPL growth to be slower than previously expected as funding for such technology slows, given it targets at-risk Americans who are far more likely to default in recessionary times. The past few years have not been kind to BNPL, with valuations plummeting and, as a result, we see the slowdown in BNPL as an opportunity for incumbent credit and debit card issuers to perfect their own BNPL solutions.

The consumer finance sub-industry is dominated by credit card issuers (nearly 90% of revenue). Smaller contributions come from student loan servicers, debt collectors, and non-bank lenders, as well as chains of pawn shops.

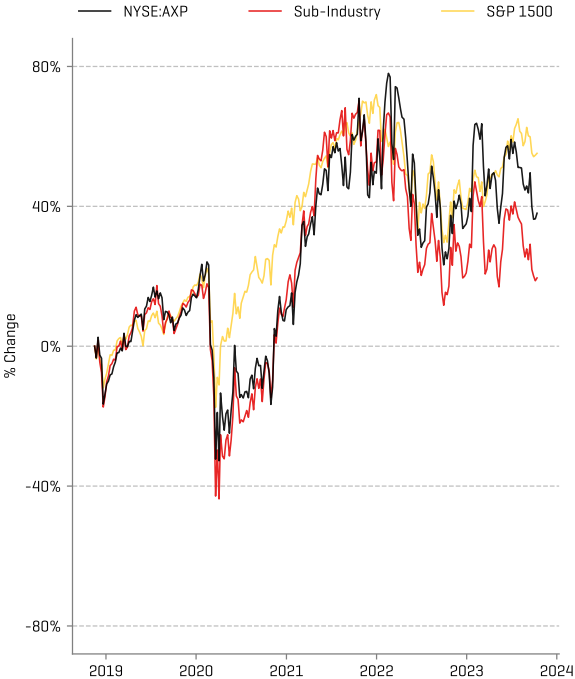
Year-to-date through September 22, the S&P Consumer Finance sub-industry was up 0.8%, compared to the broader Financials sector down 2.4% and the S&P 1500 Index up 11.6%. The sub-industry was down 20.8% in 2022, the Financials sector was down 12.1%, and the S&P 1500 Index was down 19.1%.

/ Alexander Yokum

Industry Performance

GICS Sector: Financials
Sub-Industry: Consumer Finance

Based on S&P 1500 Indexes
Five-Year market price performance through Oct 14, 2023



NOTE: A sector chart appears when the sub-industry does not have sufficient historical index data.
All Sector & Sub-Industry information is based on the Global Industry Classification Standard (GICS).
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence

Sub-Industry: Consumer Finance Peer Group*: Consumer Finance												
Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
American Express Company	AXP	NYSE	USD	151.10	111,279.0	-5.0	6.8	15.0	170.45	1.6	29.8	61.9
Ally Financial Inc.	ALLY	NYSE	USD	24.58	7,414.0	-13.3	-18.5	6.0	12.34	4.9	8.9	N/A
Capital One Financial Corporation	COF	NYSE	USD	95.20	36,313.0	-5.1	-2.7	7.0	285.59	2.5	9.8	N/A
Credit Acceptance Corporation	CACC	NasdaqGS	USD	422.93	5,423.0	-16.4	-6.0	17.0	N/A	N/A	20.6	73.1
Discover Financial Services	DFS	NYSE	USD	89.40	22,345.0	0.8	-5.0	6.0	408.29	3.1	28.4	54.0
FirstCash Holdings, Inc.	FCFS	NasdaqGS	USD	99.65	4,495.0	4.4	25.9	20.0	N/A	1.4	12.5	39.2
Nelnet, Inc.	NNI	NYSE	USD	87.88	3,280.0	-4.4	5.4	17.0	N/A	1.2	5.4	79.8
OneMain Holdings, Inc.	OMF	NYSE	USD	37.40	4,504.0	-7.4	11.6	7.0	N/A	10.7	21.3	86.3
SLM Corporation	SLM	NasdaqGS	USD	13.09	2,959.0	-6.4	-16.5	9.0	N/A	3.4	20.2	74.3
SoFi Technologies, Inc.	SOFI	NasdaqGS	USD	8.12	7,715.0	-7.7	59.5	NM	N/A	N/A	-3.5	53.3
Synchrony Financial	SYF	NYSE	USD	28.87	12,073.0	-9.2	-10.8	5.0	37.44	3.5	18.3	N/A

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

American Express Company

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

September 14, 2023

04:21 PM ET... CFRA Reiterates Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of American Express Company [AXP 168.40*****]:

We increase our 12-month target price by \$25 to \$235, applying a forward P/E of 18.3x our 2024 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 7.3x given more consistent earnings performance, lower credit risk, and superior growth prospects. We raise our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.11 to \$11.30 and decrease 2024's by \$0.15 to \$12.87. AXP reported Q2 EPS of \$2.89 vs. \$2.57, a \$0.07 earnings beat. Revenue growth slowed to 12% Y/Y as benefits from pandemic comps have been fully realized. However, we were still impressed with AXP's resilience as a slowdown in discount revenue [+8% Y/Y] was met with exceptional growth in net card fees [+21%]. Additionally, net interest income surged 32% as results benefited from strong loan growth and net interest yield expansion. Looking forward, we expect net interest income momentum to continue given strong loan growth, and we don't expect credit quality to be a significant hindrance to earnings as AXP has improved its credit profile over the past few years. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

April 20, 2023

12:01 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Strong Buy Opinion on Shares of American Express Company [AXP 158.69*****]:

We decrease our 12-month target price by \$5 to \$210, applying a forward P/E of 16.1x our '24 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 6.3x given more consistent earnings performance, lower credit risk, and superior growth prospects. We lower our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.16 to \$11.19 and reduce '24's by \$0.14 to \$13.02. AXP reports Q1 EPS of \$2.40 vs. \$2.73, a \$0.36 earnings miss. Revenue growth of 22% Y/Y accelerated given surging growth in net interest income [+36% Y/Y and 21% of revenue]. Net interest income benefited from 23% loan growth, although this was accompanied by provisions for credit losses of \$1.1 billion. Strength was also seen in net card fees [+20% Y/Y and 12% of revenue] as AXP continues to have success in bringing new accounts onto fee-paying products. Given resilient levels of spending on AXP's network, discount revenue [56% of revenue] grew 16%. However, strong growth was accompanied by 22% growth in expenses given elevated card member rewards. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

January 27, 2023

11:50 AM ET... CFRA Raises Opinion on Shares of American Express to Strong Buy From Buy [AXP 172.13*****]:

Our upgraded view reflects our forecast that AXP will further distance itself from other credit card issuers as its spend-centric business model is put on full display. Over the next two years, we expect AXP's earnings to jump well over 30%, while we expect all of its major competitors to experience earnings contraction. We expect this dichotomy to come from AXP's resilient card fees, prudent expense management, and superior credit quality that should result in fewer credit losses. We increase our 12-month target price by \$50 to \$215, applying a forward P/E of 16.3x our '24 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 7.2x. We increase our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.19 to \$11.35 and start '24's at \$13.16. AXP reports Q4 EPS of \$2.07 vs. \$2.18, a \$0.16 earnings miss. Revenue growth of 17% Y/Y was driven by net interest income [19% of revenue] up 31% as results benefited from surging loan balances. Given record levels of spending on AXP's network, discount revenue [58% of revenue] grew 14%. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

October 21, 2022

12:32 PM ET... CFRA Retains Buy Opinion on Shares of American Express Company [AXP 133.95*****]:

We lower our target price by \$25 to \$165, applying a forward P/E of 14.8x our '23 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 5.8x, given AXP's more stable earnings and spend-centric business model. We lower our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.32 to \$10.02 and decrease '23's by \$0.61 to \$11.16. AXP reports Q3 '22 EPS of \$2.47 vs. \$2.27, a \$0.06 earnings beat. Revenue growth of 24% Y/Y was a bit light, although FX headwinds resulted in 300 bps of contraction. Pressure on results also came from a \$778 million provision for credit losses, although the sizable build largely reflected loan growth and a declining macro forecast rather than deteriorating credit quality. Going forward, we continue to expect AXP to report "best in class" credit quality given AXP's highly attractive premium customers. Momentum continued in new card acquisitions as AXP added 3.3 million proprietary cards, the highest since the beginning of the pandemic. Additionally, given resilient spending, billed business rose 21%. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

July 22, 2022

10:55 AM ET... CFRA Retains Buy Opinion on Shares of American Express Company [AXP 157.23*****]:

We lower our 12-month target price by \$20 to \$190, applying a forward P/E of 16.1x our '23 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 6.0x, given AXP's more stable earnings and spend-centric business model. We raise our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.44 to \$10.34 and increase '23's by \$0.30 to \$11.77. AXP reports Q2 '22 EPS of \$2.57 vs. \$2.80 a year ago, a \$0.16 earnings beat. Revenue growth accelerated to 31% in Q2 as discount revenue [59% of revenue] growth of 30% was met with an equal 30% increase in net interest income [18% of revenue]. As we expected, T&E spending outperformed with 84% growth Y/Y and passed 2019 levels for the first-time since the onset of the pandemic. Despite the strong performance, we still see considerable upside to T&E spending as pent-up demand should significantly bolster travel spending. Credit risk quality remained excellent, and we see AXP as well positioned given its wealthy customers that can better withstand inflationary pressures. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

May 12, 2022

09:35 AM ET... CFRA Adds American Express Shares to its U.S. Women's Participation Portfolio [AXP 159.39*****]:

Our decision to add AXP shares to our Women's Participation Portfolio reflects our view that, in addition to promoting and upholding a high degree of gender diversity throughout the firm, AXP is a "best of breed" credit card operator that is well positioned to leverage a resumption in spending and travel activities (particularly business travel) in the aftermath of the pandemic. AXP posted a 29% revenue rise in Q1, and we see full year 2022 revenue growth of 19%-21% as pandemic headwinds continue to dissipate. Our 12-month target price of \$210 assumes AXP shares trade at 18.3x our 2023 EPS estimate of \$11.47 and at 21.2x our 2022 EPS estimate of \$9.90, a premium to peers we believe is justified by AXP's more stable earnings profile and superior growth prospects. AXP replaces NIKE Inc. [NKE 108 **] in the portfolio. / Catherine Seifert

April 22, 2022

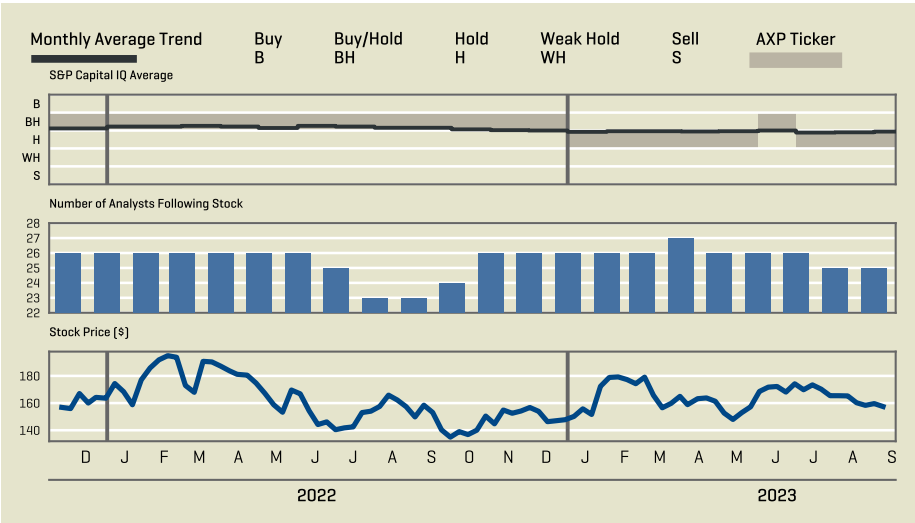
02:09 PM ET... CFRA Retains Buy Opinion on Shares of American Express Company [AXP 182.58*****]:

We raise our 12-month target price by \$20 to \$210, applying a forward P/E of 18.3x our '23 earnings estimate, a wider risk premium than the peer average of 6.7x, given AXP's more stable earnings profile and superior growth prospects. We lower our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.06 to \$9.90 and increase '23's by \$0.23 to \$11.47. AXP reports Q1 '22 EPS of \$2.73 vs. \$2.74 a year ago, a \$0.26 earnings beat as an improving operating environment led to a \$320 million reserve release. Revenue rose 29% Y/Y, driven by discount revenue [58% of revenue] up 37% and net interest income [19% of revenue] up 20%. Billed business remains strong with 31% growth Y/Y. T&E spending continues to rebound [+121% Y/Y] but remains 12% below pre-pandemic levels, while G&S spending [+21%] continues to march higher. For '22, we see strong loan growth and a continued resurgence in T&E spending leading to 19%-21% revenue growth. With competition continuing to heat up, expenses rose 34% Y/Y, with card member rewards up 39%. / Alexander Yokum, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

American Express Company

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	6	24	6	6
Buy/Hold	5	20	5	4
Hold	10	40	10	12
Weak hold	2	8	2	2
Sell	2	8	2	2
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	25	100	25	26

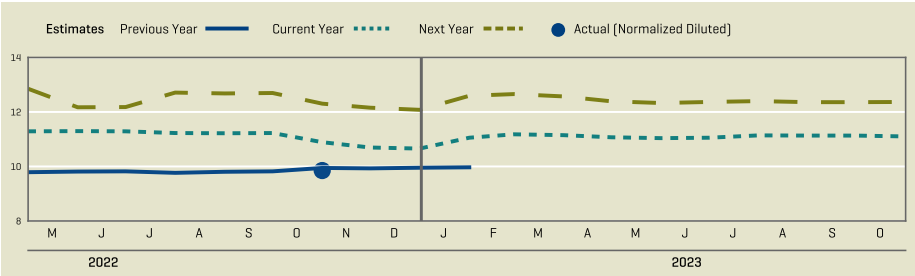
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that AXP will earn USD 11.10. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that AXP's earnings per share will grow by 11.39% to USD 12.37.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	12.37	13.05	11.64	21	12.22
2023	11.10	11.35	10.69	21	13.61
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 11%	▲ 15%	▲ 9%	N/A%	▼ -10%
Q3'24	3.15	3.40	2.91	8	47.97
Q3'23	2.95	3.23	2.83	19	51.21
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 7%	▲ 5%	▲ 3%	▼ -58%	▼ -6%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

American Express Company

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsize the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



American Express Company

Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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American Express Company

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